

Yixi Chen

PhD Candidate in Management, Columbia Business School

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EDUCATION

Columbia Business School

PhD in Management (Organizational Theory)

Dissertation: Stigma as Distinction: Identity Disclosure, Narrative Framing, and Entrepreneurial Evaluation

Committee: Paul Ingram (Chair), Adina Sterling, Dan Wang, Sandra Matz, Kylie Hwang

- **Finalist**, INFORMS/Organization Science Best Dissertation Proposal Competition (2026)

New York, NY

2027 (expected)

The University of Chicago

M.A. in Social Sciences (Concentration: Sociology)

Chicago, IL

2020

Mount Holyoke College

B.A. in History & Economics Double Major (Magna Cum Laude)

South Hadley, MA

2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Identity; Social Evaluation; Social Networks; Entrepreneurship; Computational Social Sciences

My dissertation examines a central puzzle in identity and social evaluation: when can a founder's stigmatized identity become an unexpected source of advantage rather than remaining a liability? Across studies of entrepreneurs with neurodivergent conditions and entrepreneurs with incarceration records, I develop and test the concept of *stigma as distinction*, showing how stigmatized identities can become signals of distinctiveness in contexts that reward differentiation. Using a combination of video and written-vignette experiments, surveys, and interviews, I examine how stigma disclosure shapes investor evaluations and resource acquisition.

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Chatman, J., **Chen, Y.**, Choi V., & Gelfand M. Organizational Culture and Firm Performance under Volatility: Evidence from Glassdoor. (Forthcoming at *Academy of Management Discoveries*)

Ingram, P., and **Chen, Y.** Paradox of Concealment: Incidence and Consequences of Concealing Lower-Class Identities. (2nd round Revise and Resubmit at *American Journal of Sociology*)

Chen, Y., Hwang K, Ponce de Leon, R. Entrepreneurial Storytelling and Audience Evaluation among Stigmatized Entrepreneurs. (Under Review at *Strategic Management Journal*)

Doering, L., Sterling A., and **Chen, Y.**, Gender, Feedback, and Persistence (Under Review at *American Sociological Review*)

WORKING PAPERS

Chen, Y. “Maverick or Misfit? Stigma Disclosure and the Evaluation of Neurodivergent Entrepreneurs” (**Job Market Paper**)

Chen, Y., and Ingram, P. Gender and Network Tie Decay (preparing for submission to *Academy of Management Journal*)

Chen, Y.*, Cho, S.*, Yue, L., and Minefee I., “Historical Legacies and Corporate Sociopolitical Activism: The Case of Firms’ Responses to the Black Lives Matter Movement in 2020” (preparing for submission to *Strategic Management Journal*)

Chen, Y. & Wang, S. “How Personal Narratives Reshape Racial Discrimination: Evidence from Airbnb” (second round data analysis)

OTHER PUBLICATION

Brown, Derek., **Yixi Chen**, Jenny Chatman, Sameer Srivastava, Amir Goldberg, Paul Vicinanza. “How Have Organizational Cultures Shifted During the COVID-19 Pandemic”, *California Management Review*, Vol 63, Issue 4 <https://cmr.berkeley.edu/2021/07/how-have-organizational-cultures-shifted/>

ORGANIZED SYMPOSIA

Yixi Chen & Kylie Hwang, “Marginalized Identities in Organizational Evaluation, Creative Production, and Careers”, 2026 AOM, *Showcase Symposium*

Yixi Chen & Kylie Hwang, “Navigating Inequality in Entrepreneurship: Strategies and Evaluations of Marginalized Entrepreneurs”, 2024 AOM

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* Denotates scheduled presentation

(2026) Wharton People & Organizations Conference*, Equitable Opportunity Conference, East Coast Doctoral Conference, Academy of Management

(2025) INSEAD Doriot Entrepreneurship Conference, Equitable Opportunity Conference

(2024) Oxford Reputation Conference, Academy of Management, East Coast Doctoral Conference

AWARDS & GRANTS

Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics Grant, Columbia Business School (\$5000)	2025
Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Grant, Columbia University (\$1000)	2025
Lang Center Entrepreneurship Research Grant, Columbia Business School (\$5000)	2024
Columbia University Doctoral Fellowship, Columbia Business School	2021- present

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mastercard International (New York & Shanghai)	July 2016 - August 2019
<i>Senior Analyst, International Market</i>	

TEACHING

Leadership and Organizational Change (TA for Prof. Paul Ingram)	2021-2025
Organizational Change (TA for Prof. Adina Sterling)	2025
Equity by Design (TA for Prof. Adina Sterling)	2024
Strategy Formulation (TA for Prof. Vanessa Burbano)	2024
Entrepreneurial Strategy (TA for Prof. Michael Mauskopf)	2023

SERVICE

PhD Mentor for Columbia Undergraduate Business Scholars Program (2022 – 2026)
Co-organizer for 2024 East Coast Doctoral Conference (2024)
Organizer for weekly Macro PhD Students brownbag seminar (2023-2024)
Ad hoc reviewer for the Academy of Management annual meetings (2022-present)